

Mata o Muna 2

Fakavae Akenga o Faifaiga Aliko o Nanumea

I te Mata o Muna 1, ni maua i ai a te kamataga o te fenua ko Nanumea, kae pelā hoki ko maga aliki kola e 'tu ki te tagata takutakua mua a tātou ko Tefolaha. A te mata o muna tenei e lavea i ai a hekehekega o fakamatalaga o kāiga e uiga ki te fakatokaiga o faiga a aliki o Nanumea. A tala konei ni kamata mai katoa i tama a Tefolaha, kolā a olotou igoa koa mahani i ai a tātou katoa. I te senitenali ni oko muamua mai i ai a Tefolaha ki Nanumea, e tokouke a takitaki takutakua mo olotou kāiga ni olo tele i loto i te taimi tenei. Kae i te gahologa o senitenali konei e i ai ni taimi o te toka, ka e i ai hoki taimi o taua i luga o Nanumea. A ni taua e lavea i ai a Nanumea mo tona taumafai o puipui a ia mai toa mai fenua mai tua (pelā Tonga, Kilipati). Kae ko ni taua e fai hoki ailoa i luga o Nanumea i te va o tino takitokotahi.

E hē ai he auala o hiki ki lalo me o tuku ifo tala mua o te fenua katoa. Manatuga o mea koa oti ni tupu mo tino takutakua ni tausi gina i tala mua i loto o kāiga. A kāiga konei, kae hē ko te fenua katoa, koa leoleo a tala mua e uiga mo faifaiga mo mea tupu i 'tou fenua. A tala konei e fakamanatu a igoa mo faifaiga o tupuga o kāiga konei i pō mua. A tala konā e fai mo fai he fakavae o tulaga o kāiga mai loto i faifaiga faka te pulepulega o te fenua.

Ko Āvaga mo Tamaliki a Tefolaha

Kae fai koe e noho i te āhiga o Nanumea kae fakalogo ki tala a toeaina e fai, e hē poi koe o lavea a te heke'heke a olotou tala e fai. A toeaina konei e afu mai kāiga mo maga hekeheke, mo olotou mafaufauga mo muna totino e tupu mai mafaufauga o toeaina konei, kae e aumai hoki kae fakavae mai faifaiga mahani a olotou kāiga kola ni 'tupu ake i ai a lātou. A olotou tala ko tala mua a te fenua mo tātou katoa. Tela koa lahi a te iloa me i o'tou tala mua (ko tala kolā e hē ni tuhi ki lalo i pepa, kae ni talagutu kae manatua ki he taimi leva) e hē 'pau, ka e heke'heke ailoa a ologa o tala. Telā lā a tala mua o Nanumea – e i ai ailoa ni heke'hekega mai tala e uiga ki āvaga mo tamaliki a Tefolaha.

I te mata o muna tenei koa faka akutu tala mua ki luga i te fakavae akega o te aliki o Nanumea. A tala

Chapter 2

Origins of Nanumea's Chiefly Traditions

Chapter 1 traced the beginnings of Nanumean society, and especially our chiefly lineages, to our famous ancestor, Tefolaha. This chapter takes a close look at some of the differing family traditions explaining the development of Nanumea's chiefly system. These stories all begin with the children of Tefolaha, children whose names are familiar to us all. In the centuries since Tefolaha first came ashore at Nanumea, many important leaders and their families have come and gone. As the generations passed there were periods of peace as well as periods of war in Nanumea. Some of the wars involved Nanumeans defending themselves against outside invaders (from Tonga, Kiribati, etc). Other struggles have been internal ones pitting Nanumeans against each other.

There was no mechanism for recording or handing down traditions or history which related to the island as a whole. Memories of events and individuals remembered today have been preserved as narratives handed down within families. Nanumean extended families, and not the community as a whole, have guarded the traditions explaining important events of our island. These family traditions always focus on the names and actions of key family members of the past. They also justify a family's position within the islands' political structure.

The Wives and Children of Tefolaha

If you sit in the āhiga of Nanumea and listen to different elders speak, you would not be surprised that the stories they tell differ somewhat. They come from different social and political groups and their opinions reflect not only their own personal views, but are grounded in the traditions of the family they have been raised in. Their stories are our history – our oral history. It is widely known that oral history (history that is not written, but is passed down by word of mouth from one listener to another and remembered) is variable, that it always exists in differing versions. And so it is with Nanumea's history – there are several differing versions of the historical narratives about the wives and children of Tefolaha.

In this chapter we have gathered together historical narratives about the origin of Nanumea's chiefly

konei e fai pelā mo ata o vaega hekeheke lahi o tala mua o Nanumea. A te motou faiga ke hē 'kau a matou i he faitu e tahi, kae koa noho ailoa a mātou i te gāloto. Kae telā lā, koa oti ailoa ni fakaali atu a omotou mea ni maua a tala tāua konei, ke fai ni pulaga a koutou ki ai. Koa mafai a fakamatatalagina he tala mua gali tela koa fia'fia kae fakamata'mata ki ai a tino Nanumea katoa.

Koli mo ona Tuagane

E tonu a gutu o tamaliki a Tefolaha mo Laukite e pelā katoa mo gutu katoa mo gutu o te ika ko te pāla? E i ai ni tino e talitonu ki ai. E tonu a lātou ni 'ta katoa a tefolaha me 'kai tino? Kae ko tana tama fāfine ko Koli ni fakahao me hē kai tino? Ka e tonu i a Koli ni āvaga, kae ko tona fakahologa e i ai he ona tulaga tāua i loto i aliki o Nanumea? Au tali ki fesili konei e hē motuhia e pogai hoki ailoa mai tala mua a ou kāiga. E uke a matakāiga lahi i luga o Nanumea i pō nei e fai pelā i a Koli ko tona tupuga tonu mai mua, me he tugane o olotou tupuga.

Ni fakamatala e te toeaina ko Tepou a te tala mua o tona kāiga kia Kiti mo Ane i te 1970 ki mua mo te 1980 hoki ki mua. I te tala a Tepou, a Tefolaha ni hau mai Samoa (hē ko Tonga pelā mo te mau a te ukega o kāiga). I te otiga ni fakaloiloi e Tefolaha a Pai mo Vau, āvaga i ai a ia ki te atua ko Laukite. Muna Tepou me i te igoa tenei o te āvaga muamua a Tefolaha e hē lahi a te iloa i Nanumea, kae he vaega o te tala faka te kāiga o lātou ni logo i ai a ia. A Tefolaha e ia ai he ona faitu aitu, kae he faitu tino hoki. A Laukite ni fanau e ia he tama fāfine. A te kauvae o te tamaliki e loa, mo ona nifo e mata'kai pelā ailoa mo nifo o te ika ko te pāla. Kae ko ia e kai tino hoki, tela ni 'ta ia e Tefolaha. Ni toe fanau hoki a Laukite, he tamaliki fāfine hoki mo tona gutu ika, kae e kai tino hoki. Toe 'ta hoki a ia nei. E tokofā katoa a tamaliki fāfine penei, kae ni 'ta katoa e Tefolaha. A lātou tamaliki konei ko Lei, Finehau, Moega no Nenefu.

Fakamuli ifo ni toe maua e te taulua āvaga nei he tamaliki e hē kai tino, vagana ko tona gutu koi pelā ailoa mo te gutu o te ika. A te tama fāfine tenei ko Koli ko te tama tonu muamua ailoa a Tefolaha. Ni tupu ake a Koli, kae ni tuku e Tefolaha ki ai a te pulega o te fenua -- ni tuku ki ai a te aliki. I te taimi tenei, a Tefolaha e fakaoga a tona faitu aitu, muna a Tepou. E tokolua hoki a tamaliki ni toe maua fakamuli, ni tamaliki tāgata kae ni fānau mai i tona faitu tino. A Tefolaha ni manako o toe foki ki tona fenua tonu ko Samoa. Ni tuku e ia kia Koli a te pule ki tamaliki foliki konei.

system. The examples here represent the major variations found in our historical traditions. Our goal has been not to take sides, not to join one or another political faction. Rather, we have put our discoveries, these important stories, on display for all to view them. They present a rich history, something that all Nanumeans can be proud of.

Koli and her Brothers

Did Tefolaha and Laukite have children who all had mouths like the pāla fish? Some people believe so. Did Tefolaha kill them all, because they were cannibals? Or did his daughter Koli escape because she was not a cannibal? Did Koli marry and are her descendants today in a special position in relation to the chiefs of Nanumea? Your answers to these questions will probably depend on your own family traditions. There are many extended families on Nanumea today that claim Koli as their key ancestor or as a sister of one of their ancestors.

The elder Tepou explained his family's history to Kiti and Ane in the 1970's, and again in the 1980's. According to Tepou, Tefolaha came from Samoa (not Tonga, as many other family traditions assert). After tricking Pai and Vau, Tefolaha married the atua Laukite. The name of Tefolaha's first wife is not widely known in Nanumea, Tepou said, but was part of the family tradition handed down to him. Tefolaha himself had both an aitu and a human nature. Laukite gave birth to a girl. The baby had a jutting jaw with sharp teeth, much like a pāla fish. She was also a cannibal, so Tefolaha killed her. Again Laukite gave birth, and again the daughter had a fish mouth and was a cannibal, and he killed her. In all there were four daughters like this, and all were killed by Tefolaha: Lei, Finehau, Moega, and Nenefu.

Finally, the couple had a child who was not a cannibal, though her mouth was still like that of a fish. This daughter, Koli, was Tefolaha's first real child. She grew up and to her Tefolaha entrusted the rule of Nanumea – to her he gave the aliki. Thus far, Tefolaha had been acting in his spirit, aitu, nature, Tepou explained. Now, he had two further children, sons who were born to his human side. Tefolaha wanted to return to his homeland, Samoa. He left Koli in charge of the two small boys.

Koa fano ailoa a taimi, kae ko Teilo mo Tepaa e olo ake ailoa o mātua. Ni tuku e Koli ki ona tuagane ke pule i te fenua, pelā mo te tukuatuga e Tefolaha kia te ia. Ana muna penei, "O'mai o noho pelā me ni pule, me ia te aku he fafine. A toku tofi ko te noho kae pulapula i luga o te fenua." Ni fakatonu e Koli a te mea tenei, tela ni fai i ai a Teilo mo Tepa mo aliki. Oko ki te taimi ni toe foki mai i ai a Tefolaha mai tana malaga. Muna a Koli ki a te ia, "Tefolaha, koa oti ni tuku e aku a te tofi pule ki oku tuagane, ke 'noho pelā me ni aliki. Kae ko toku tofi, ke tuku ailoa pelā mo te mea ni fai mai ai a koe ki te aku. Ko aku ailoa tokotahi e pulepeule i te fenua." Ni tali atu a Tefolaha. "Ia, e 'lei ailoa ke fai pēna."

Mai te taimi nei ki mua, a Teilo mo Tepaa koa tausi nei e lāua a te fenua, takitokotahi ailoa i tona taimi, kae ko Koli koa noho o pula ki a lā mea 'sē ni fai. A Teilo ko ia ko te tama lahi, ko ia hoki ailoa ko te aliki muamua, Te Aliko a Mua. Ka ko Tepaa mo tona gafa, Te Aliko a Muli, manafai e noho i te nohoaga koa kata (faka tāuga) ki te uke a ika o te papa, kae uke hoki a gā ika e olo pili ki matakatoga. Konei a fakailoga o maga aliki konei e lua.

I te toe fokiga a Tefolaha, ni o'mai mo ia he āvaga fou. Muna a Tepou me i te tokoukega o tino e fai pelā me he fafine Tonga. Ni o'mai tahi mo lāua a lā tamaliki tagata tokotolu ko Tutaki, Fiaola mo Lavega. Ka ko muna a Tefolaha ki a lātou tokotolu: "Ke o'mai koutou o tautua a outou taina matua konei e tokolua."

A te galuega a Tutaki, ko ia tela e lahi, ko te tufuga o mea manafai e i ai he faigamea e fai i te ahiga. Ka ko Fiaola, te tama i te tokolua, ko ia e pule i te vaevaega o meakai i te ahiga. Kae ki te tamaliki foliki ko Lavega, ni tuku e Tefolaha ki ai a te tausi o te aliki. E i ai hoki he malosio o Lavega o pule a te matagi, tela ke fanofano 'lei i ai a te malaga a te aliki i te tuga malie o te matagi. Pelā lā, a te kāiga o Lavega ko latou ko te Aliko o te Tai.

Kae i luga o te laukele, a te pologa tonu a Lavega ko te pulepulega o te fakahopoga o he aliki fou. Ko ia hoki e fakatoka a te faiga o te fakahopoga o te aliki. E fakatonu atu a ia penei ki te fenua: "Konei a o'tou mea e fai ki te fakahopoga o te aliki...."

Telā lā a te tokotolu taina (afa taina) fo'liki konei, e tofi ailoa mo olotou tui o tautua a te fenua mo te aliki hopo o te fenua. A te tala a te kāiga o Tepou mo Molaulau mai mea tenei, e mafai o hē iloa e tino Nanumea katoa.

A Tepou, fakatahi mo tona kāiga, e fai ailoa pelā me ia Teilo ko te tama lahi, telā ko ia ko Te Aliko a Mua.

Time passed, and Teilo and Tepaa grew up. Their sister gave to them the chieftainship of Nanumea, which Tefolaha had given her. She said, "Come and sit as chiefs, because I am a woman. My position, though, will be to remain and watch over this island." Koli ordered this and so Teilo and Tepaa became chiefs. Eventually, Tefolaha returned from his voyage. Koli said to him, "Tefolaha, I have given the chieftainship to my brothers, to sit as chiefs. But my position will be to remain just as you told me. It is I alone who am in charge of the island." Tefolaha replied, "Well, that is all right."

From this point on Teilo and Tepaa reigned, each in his own turn, while Koli remained to oversee their actions and to tell them when they did something wrong. Teilo, the firstborn son, was to be the first chief, Te Aliko a Mua. When Tepaa or his descendants, Te Aliko a Muli, reigned, his blessing was that there were plentiful reef fish and huge schools of fish which swarmed close to shore. The coconut crop was also abundant. These blessings were the hallmarks, failoga, of these two chiefs.

When Tefolaha returned, he brought with him a new wife. Tepou said that people generally said that she had come from Tonga. With them came their three sons, Tutaki, Fiaola and Lavega. Tefolaha said to these three: "You are to come and serve your two older brothers."

The duty of Tutaki, the eldest, was to distribute things whenever there was something going on in the Āhiga. Fiaola, the next son, was to be in charge of the division of food in the Āhiga. To the youngest son, Lavega, Tefolaha gave the responsibility to care for (tausi) the reigning chief. Lavega also had powers to control the winds so that canoe voyages made by the reigning chief were assured of a favorable wind. Lavega's group were thus the "Chiefs of the Sea," Aliko o te Tai.

On land, however, Lavega's main responsibility lay in overseeing the process of installing a new chief. He would speak to the representatives of the chiefly families about this. He was also in charge of the arrangements for the installation ceremony, fakahopoga.

So it is that the three younger brothers (half brothers) all had responsibilities to serve the island and the reigning chief of Nanumea. This family tradition may not be known by all Nanumeans, of course, though we believe that many people have heard of Koli and of her special position.

Tepou continued with his family tradition, saying that Teilo as the eldest son was known as Te Aliko a

Ka ko tona taina foliki ko Tepaa ko Te Aliko a Muli. A te Aliko a Mua mo te Aliko a Muli ko aliki tonu ailoa konei o Nanumea, muna a Tepou. I pō mua ko lātou ailoa konei e pule, e taki tokotahi ailoa ia lāua konei e fakaholo ke fai mo pule. Kae i pō fakamuli nei, a maga aliki lagolago koa kāmata hoki o 'tofi ni aliki mai olotou maga.

Faka Hologa o Likilua

A Teilo mo Tepaa e hē motuhia koa iloa kae iloa talia e tino Nanumea ko maga fakaipitoa e lua konei pelā mo te fakamatalaga a Tepou: te Aliko a Mua mo te Aliko a Muli. Ka e hē ko talamua faka-Nanumea katoa e talia e latou, me ia Teilo mo Tepaa ni tamaliki a Tefolaha. Ka e ia ai hoki he tala lauiloa e tahi, koa tavili a tātou ki ai e fai mai me i a lāua konei ni toe ola ake fakamuli. A lāua hoki e hē ni tuagane o Koli, me i te tala tenei e hē ai ni tuagane mo tama a Koli. A Teilo mo Tepaa e hē ni taina me ni afa-taina o Tutaki, Fiaola mo Lavega, kae ni tupu mai a lāua mai te gafa o Lavega.

A te tala mua e tafa mai nei, ni hau ia Takitua, telā he toeaina takutakua e tokotahi i Nanumea mai te 1950 o fano ailoa ki te 1970. A te tala a Takitua e uiga ki te kamataga o aliki o Nanumea, fai mai me i ā Tefolaha he toa o Tonga, i taimi koi faitaua tele i ai a Tonga, Fiti mo Samoa. Fakatahi mo tino Tonga ake, a Tefolaha ni taua kae ni manumālō i fenua katoa konā, kae ni lauiloa a ia me he tagata tau fakamataku. Ni noho a ia i Samoa kae ni āvaga a ia ki te fafine Samoa e igoa ki a Teati. E hē ai he alā tama ni maua, tiaki i ai e ia, kae faima'laga mo ona faoa o pula'pula ki fenua 'fou.

A Tefolaha mo Puleala e tokotolu a lā tamaliki tagata, kae ni fa'nau katoa i Nanumea. A te tama lahi ko Tutaki, tafa atu ko Fiaola, kae ko te tama foliki ko Lavega. Ni a'vaga katoa a lātou konei, kae fakavae mai i ai a olotou telega ke oko mai ailoa ki pō nei. Kae koi tuai o mate a Tefolaha, e i ai he ana togi ni fai. A tana tama foliki ko Lavega, ko ia ke fai mo aliki, kae ko ona taina, ke maua hoki ni olotou galuega: o tausi kae o puipui a te aliki. A Tutaki, te tama lahi ni tuku ki ai a te mea taua a Tefolaha ko te Kaumaile, kae ke fakaogā mo puipui ki ai a Lavega.

Ko te telega o Lavega ko ia ko te aliki pule o Nanumea, ko te telega telā ni fakatele ifo e Takitua ki tona tamana mo ia hoki ailoa, tela ko te 22 kautama mai tua o Lavega. I te tala tenei e i ai he mea tāua ni tupu mai i te lua o kautama mai tua o Tefolaha, telā ni fakatino 'lei mai i ai a te nohoaga

Mua, "the first chief," while his younger brother Tepaa was Te Aliko a Muli, "the behind chief." Te Aliko a Mua and Te Aliko a Muli are the true chiefs of Nanumea, he said. In ancient times it was only they who reigned, each providing a ruling chief in turn. In recent times, some of the other supporting lineages of chiefs have begun to provide chiefs from time to time.

Likilua's Heritage

Teilo and Tepaa are no doubt universally associated by Nanumeans with the two key lineages which Tepou's story identifies, Te Aliko a Mua and Te Aliko a Muli. But not all Nanumean traditional histories agree that Teilo and Tepaa are sons of Tefolaha, as the story above says. In fact, a prominent tradition which we will now consider argues that these two men came later in Nanumea's history. And they were not brothers of Koli at all, since this story says that Koli had no brothers and no descendants. Nor were Teilo and Tepaa brothers, or half brothers, of Tutaki, Fiaola and Lavega, but in fact they descend from Lavega.

This next oral history account came from Takitua, an influential elder in Nanumea in the period of the 1950s through the 1970s. Takitua's version of the origin of Nanumea's chiefs tells us that Tefolaha was a Tongan warrior, in the days when Tonga, Fiji and Samoa were continually at war. With a group of other Tongan warriors, Tefolaha fought successfully in all those places, gaining a reputation as a fierce fighter. He remained in Samoa and married a Samoan woman named Teati. She bore him no children, however, and he left her and with his crew went voyaging looking for new lands.

Tefolaha and Puleala had three sons, all born in Nanumea. Oldest was Tutaki, next was Fiaola, and youngest was Lavega. Each eventually married, and all founded lines which have continued on to the present day. Before his death, Tefolaha made a will. His youngest son, Lavega, was to succeed him as chief, aliki, while his brothers were to have supporting roles. Tutaki, the eldest, received Tefolaha's war spear, Te Kaumaile, and was to use it to protect Lavega. The Kaumaile has come down in the line of Tutaki's descendants and today (2026) is cared for by the Pulefenua.

Lavega's line provided the ruling aliki of Nanumea, a line which Takitua traced down to his father and to himself, about 22 generations after Lavega. In this tradition there was an important event two generations after Tefolaha that would henceforth shape Nanumea's chieftainship. This was a

aliki. A te mea tenei he ma'vaega o te maga o Lavega. Ko te tama tagata a Lavega ko Likilua. A Likilua ni āvaga mo Lofale, te tama a Tutaki. E toko tolu tama tāgata a Likilua mo Lofale, ko Tematua, Teuhie mo Temahafu. Ni logo a Likilua me i tona tamana pelā me fiafai (mataifale) mo tona āvaga ko Lofale, tela hola i ai keatea mo Nanumea.

Tenā lā ni fono a ana tama kolā e tokotolu i Nanumea kae ni iku ke tiaki e lātou a Nanumea pelā hoki mo te olotou nohoaga aliki. I te galo atuga o te olotou vaka, a Teuhie ni moe, kae ko te tokolua ake e fai'tala. Muna a Tematua me ia te ia e hē manako o tiaki a tona aliki. Ni fai atu i ai a Temahafu ki tona taina kae fai e manako a ia o toe foki ki Nanumea, e 'lei ke gā fano a ia kae koi moe a te lā taina ake. A Tematua ni foki ailoa ki Nanumea. Fakamuli ifo kae ala ake a Teuhie. I te oko atuga a Teuhie ki Nanumea, ni lavea e ia i tona auala ni 'pono mai a aitu fāfine konei. Toe foki hoki i ai a ia ki te vaka, toe faka'hoko atu i ai a te lā malaga mo tona taina ko Temahafu. Hē iloa atu ailoa me ni olo ki fea.

A Tematua ni fai mo aliki o Nanumea. Kae e fakafanoanoa 'kī a te ia a te 'galo atuga a ona taina, kae i te pō e tahi ni fano o 'hala ki a lāua. Ni oko atu a tona vaka ki Niutao, noho ailoa i konā. Ni āvaga a ia mo te fāfine Niutao e igoa ki a Hikiga, kae ni fai a te lā tama tagata kae ni fakaigoa ki a Teilo. I te pō e tahi ni moemiti a Tematua. Tona tupuga ko Tefolaha ni hau ki a te ia i te moemiti, kae fai atu ki a te ia ke toe foki ki Nanumea o fai a tona aliki. A Tematua (e talitonu a tātou me ko ia mo tona āvaga ko Hikiga mo te lā tama ko Teilo) ni 'toe foki ki Nanumea. Ni maua atu e ia me i te kāiga o tana āvaga Nanumea koa taumafai ke maua e latou a te tulaga aliki, kae ni mafai o toe fakafoki mai e ia.

Mai āvaga e tokolua mo tamaliki tagata o te kaufale tenei, ni ma'fua ake i ai a maga aliki e lua. Mai tana āvaga Nanumea telā ni hau i ai a Tepaa, telā a tona maga e taku ko te Aliko a Muli, me e fai mai a te tala, me ia Nanumea e tū mai tua (muli) faka'pau ki te tulaga o te fenua ko Niutao. Ka ko te telega o te tama e tokotahi ko Teilo e 'taku pelā ko te Aliko a Mua me mai te tulaga o Nanumea, a Niutao e tū ki mua o Nanumea. A lāua nei, konei ailoa e noho i te tulaga aliki, fanaifo mai a Tefolaha telā a te telega o Teilo ko te Aliko a Mua, kae ko Tepaa ko te Aliko a Muli.

E tahi hoki a te mea tāua ni tupu mo mai te tulaga i pō nei o te maga Tūmau telā e kau i ai a Takitua mo ona kano. I te tala tenei, a maga aliki e lua kolā koa oti ni 'taku atu a olā igoa mai luga, e tūmau ailoa o fakahuihui a lāua o 'pono a te nohoaga aliki o Nanumea i loto i kautama e uke. Fai mai a te tuhi a

branching which took place in Lavega's line. Lavega's son was Likilua. Likilua married Lofale, who was believed to be a daughter of Tutaki. Likilua and Lofale's three sons were Tematua, Teuhie and Temahafu. Likilua learned that his father, Lavega, was having an incestuous affair with his wife, Lofale, and so he fled from Nanumea.

Meanwhile, his three sons met at Nanumea and decided they would leave Nanumea and abandon their claim to the chieftainship. As their canoe sailed away, one brother, Teuhie, slept. The other two talked. Tematua said that he really did not wish to abandon the chieftainship. Temahafu advised his brother that if he wanted to return to Nanumea, he should do so while the other brother slept. So Tematua returned to Nanumea. Teuhie later woke up. When he learned that Tematua had gone, he went after him. When Teuhie got to Nanumea, he saw that his way was blocked by the women spirits. He returned to the canoe and he and his brother Temahafu continued on their way. It is not known where they went.

Tematua remained in Nanumea as aliki. He was saddened at the loss of his brothers, though, and one day he went to look for them. His canoe reached Niutao and he remained there. He married a Niutao woman named Hikiga and they had a son named Teilo. One day Tematua dreamed. His ancestor Tefolaha came to him in the dream and told him to return to Nanumea to his chieftainship. Tematua (and, we believe, his wife Hikiga and their son Teilo) returned to Nanumea. He found that the family of his Nanumean wife had assumed the chiefly prerogatives, but he was able to gain these back.

From Tematua's two wives, and the two sons of those unions, came two lines of aliki. From the Nanumean wife came Tepaa, whose line is known as Te Aliko a Muli because, this account says, Nanumea lies "behind," muli in its relationship to the island of Niutao. The line of the other son, Teilo, is known as Te Aliko a Mua because of its Niutao descent. Tematua's son with his Nanumea wife was Tepaa; his son with his Niutao wife, Hikiga, was Teilo. Both sons continued the chiefly descent line from Tefolaha, with Teilo's line called Te Aliko a Mua and Tepaa's called Te Aliko a Muli.

One other important event created the position today of the lineage Tūmau, of which Takitua was a member. In this account, the two lineages of chiefs named above alternated in providing the aliki of Nanumea, and generations passed. According to Takitua's ledger book, it was in the tenth generation

Takitua, me ko te fuagafulu o kautama mai tua o Tepaa ni oko mai i ai ki Nanumea e te kautau mai Kilipati ki mātū. A takitaki o te kautau tenei ni tino Beru, ka e manatua i Nanumea i pō nei mai olotou igoa faka Nanumea: Taitai mo Temotu. A Taitai mo Temotu mo te putukau a lāua ni mafai e lātou o fakaleia a Nanumea kae 'tuli keatea katoa a ona aliki mo te fenua. Ni 'hola atu ki fenua tai pili mai o Tuvalu, Nanumaga mo Niutao.

Atu lā koa talitonu a toa o Kilipati me koa 'to katoa ki te tai aliki o Nanumea, kae telā lā e toe tokotahi ailoa koi toe i luga o te fenua. A logotau ni 'to kau i te Taumalo i te taimi telā. A tona tamana ko Togia koa oti ni mate, ka e 'noho nei a ia mo tona mātua ko Paua. A te tuagane o Paua ko Maatio telā ni fesoasoani o faka'muni a Logotau mai a Taitai. A Teeputi, he tuagane o Taitai, e mahala i mea fakataula aitu telā ni fai ki ai me toe tokotahi a te aliki koi toe nei i luga o Nanumea.

I te logoga a Maatio me ia Taitai koa taumafai nei o tā a tona lāmutu ko Logotau, fakatoka i ai he ana togafiti. Ni fakatonu e ia a tāgata Nanumea ke 'tua mai ni pou, kae ke aumai ki te fa'kai, telā koa fakafou i ai e lātou a te āhiga o te fenua. A fāfine katoa ke teu'teu fakagaligali me tenei a te pō koa tā i ai e lātou a Taitai. A Taitai ni kau fakatahi i te keliga o poko o pou o te āhiga fou, koa poko a te matagi a tou tagata. I te taimi tonu ailoa telā koa oti ni fakatino e lātou, puke mai a olotou tao ni 'fu pili mai, ko te mea ailoa koa velo e latou a Taitai. A tona tauhoa ko Temotu ni tā hoki ailoa i te taimi nei pelā hoki ailoa mo te tāga o Taitai. A Nanumea koa saoloto nei mai pulepelega a te fili mai Kilipati.

Mai te taimi o te 'tuliga o lātou keatea mo te fenua, a aliki o Nanumea ni fakaogā a olotou mahala aitu i te pula mao ke iloa ake e lātou me he ā nei a te tulaga o te fenua. Ni 'pula kae lavea ake e lātou me koa 'lei a mea katoa i luga o Nanumea. Ni loto ma'lie a lātou o fakataufai a olotou vaka ki Nanumea, kae ko ia telā e oko muamua, ko ia tenā koa fai mo aliki hopo. Aliko ni fakataufai o foki mai mai Nanumaga mo Niutao, kae ni fakafetaui mai a lātou i tai i matakatoga e te tamatāne telā ni noho tūmau ailoa i konā, ko Longotau.

Ni 'hili atu a Longotau, "A koutou nā ni olo katoa ki fea? A tinā tagata tonu konei ailoa e 'noho ailoa o inu toto, kae ni 'galo a koutou ki fea?"

Aliko koa oko ailoa i te 'ma kae fai ake a olotou muna penei, "Koa 'lei lā, noho ailoa penā kae fai a te fenua mō ou fenua." Koa tuku e lātou a te nohoaga aliki o Nanumea ki a Logotau.

Kae ni tali atu a ia ki te lukuga o aliki, "Ikai. O'mai katoa a koutou o fai a te nohoaga aliki. Aku e noho atu mai tua o pulapula ki otou galuega. Kae fai he

after Tepaa that Nanumea was invaded by a war party from Kiribati to the north. The warriors leading this group were from Beru, and are remembered in Nanumea today by their Nanumean names, Taitai and Temotu. Besides a crew of warriors, they were accompanied to Nanumea by their sister Teeputi. Taitai and Temotu and their group were able to conquer Nanumea and banish all the chiefs, who fled to nearby Tuvalu islands, some to Nanumaga, some to Niutao.

Although the Gilbertese warriors believed that all the chiefs of Nanumea had been driven out, in fact one remained on the island. Logotau was still a young, unmarried man at the time. His father, Togia, had died and he lived with his mother, Paua. Paua's brother Maatio helped Logotau hide from Taitai. Teeputi, sister of Taitai, was skilled in magic, which told her that one chief remained on Nanumea.

When Maatio realized that Taitai was plotting to kill his lāmutu (sister's son) Logotau, he made a plan. He told the men of Nanumea to cut posts and bring them to the village, where they would renew the island's meeting hall. The women were all to dress festively. Taitai joined in the digging of the post holes for the new meeting house, encouraged by the admiring young women dressed in garlands and dancing on the sidelines. At the proper moment the men stabbed Taitai repeatedly as he was digging. Though he had magical powers, Taitai was finally overcome before he could reach the house of his sister. His fellow warrior, Temotu, was killed at the same time. And in this way, Nanumea became free of the rule of the Gilbertese invaders.

During the time of their banishment, the chiefs of Nanumea used magical seeing devices to check on the situation at home. Now they looked and saw that all was clear on Nanumea. They agreed among themselves that they would race their canoes to Nanumea and the first to arrive would be the ruling chief. The chiefs raced back from Nanumaga and Niutao, only to be met on the beach by the young man who had remained there all along, Logotau.

Logotau asked, "Where did you all go? The real men remained here to drink blood, and where did you go?"

The chiefs were ashamed, and replied, "All right, you stay and make the island your island." They offered the chieftainship of Nanumea to Logotau.

However, he said to the group of chiefs, "No, you, all of you, come and accept the position of the ruling chief. I will sit behind and oversee your work. If there is someone whose work is not good, I will tell that

tino e hē 'lei ana galuega, e mafai e aku o fai ki he tino ke tukuifo kae ke fanatu he tino 'lei o hui a ia."

Koi fano ailoa a te fakamatalaga a Takitua, ana muna me i tona telega, ni hau ia Logotau, ni fai a ia mo takitaki o te Kau Aliko o Nanumea. A te nohoaga aliki e o lātou ake ailoa, kae pelā mo te faka'tauga ni fai e Logotau, a te pologa nei a lātou kae oko ki te pō nei ko te pula ki te tulaga o te Aliko. Ka fai a te Aliko e hē 'lei a tana pulepulega, ko te maga o Logotau e i ai a tona malosio fai ki ai ke fakatafa ake mo te papa (nohoaga aliki) kae ke toe fili he aliki fou mai maga aliki ake. A tona igoa ake ko Tūmau, e fakauiga ki te olotou tino mua tenā ko Logotau, telā ni noho tūmau i Nanumea kae ko aliki ake ni 'polo keatea.

I te fakamatalaga a Takitua i te fakavae akega o te faiga aliki o Nanumea, e fitu a maga aliki mai mua, ka e tū katoa ki te tama foliki tenei a Tefolaha ko Lavega. E fitu ailoa a maga aliki katoa, kae muna a Takitua me e lua mai a lātou konei e i ai ni fakamanuiaga tāua e olotahi mo taimi e pule i ai a latou. Kae fai ni aliki mai maga konei, te Aliko a Mua me ko te Aliko a Muli, e pule i te fenua, a Nanumea koa fakamanuiagina ki te uke o ika moana, ika o te papa mo ika o te namo, kae uke hoki a niu.

Fakapaupauga a Tala a Tepou mo Takitua

A tala konei e lua koa oti ni 'pula a tātou ki ai e i ai hoki ailoa ni faitu e tai heke malosio i ai. Kae ko matakāiga konei e lua, mo alā faiga mua e uiga mō Tefolaha, e uke hoki ailoa a faitu e fealofani ('pau) i ai a lāua. A faitu e 'pau i ai konei:

- A Tefolaha ko te tupuga mai te kamataga ailoa o Nanumea.
- Ni mafua ake i ai a pulepulega aliki o pō nei mai a Tefolaha mo ana tama.
- Ko te kata me ko te tāuga telā e maua e Nanumea (tona tai mo tona uluniu) manafai e pule a telega konei o Tepaa me ko Teilo.
- A te telega o Tūmau e tautua a te Aliko/Pulefenua ki te fai o ia mo te Aliko o te Tai.
- E i ai hoki ni telega aliki i Nanumea ake kolā e ia ai ni olotou pologa e tautua i ai e lātou a te Aliko/Pulefenua, pelā mo te kau o te Tufa mo te kau o te Nifo.
- E i ai he pologa tāua pelā 'tino tausi,' telā ko 'te noho kae pula' me 'ko te agatonu' ki te

person to step down and let someone else who is good take over."

So, Takitua explained, his lineage, the descendants of Logotau, became the leaders of the chiefs of Nanumea. The chieftainship was rightfully theirs alone, but because of Logotau's decision, his lineage's duty would be, from that time on, to watch over the chieftainship. If the ruling chief behaved improperly, Logotau's lineage had the power to ask him to step down and to appoint the next ruling chief from among the various chiefly branches, maga. An alternate name for this lineage is Tūmau, referring to the fact that its founding ancestor, Logotau, steadfastly remained (tūmau) in Nanumea when the other chiefs fled.

In Takitua's explanation of the foundations of the Nanumean chieftainship, there are seven chiefly descent groups (maga), all of which trace descent from Lavega, the youngest son of Tefolaha. Although there are seven lineages in all, Takitua explained that two of them have a special "blessing" or manuia associated with their rule. When chiefs from either Te Aliko a Mua and Te Aliko a Muli lineages reign, Nanumea is blessed with plentiful fish in the ocean, reef and lagoon, and a bountiful harvest of coconuts.

Contrasting the Two Core Stories

The two stories we have considered here differ in some important ways, but these two different family traditions about Tefolaha also agree on many points. These points of agreement are important because they offer a solid foundation for the chieftainship of Nanumea. The points of agreement are:

- Tefolaha is the founding ancestor of Nanumea
- Today's chieftainship derives from Tefolaha through descent from his children
- There is a special "blessing," a kata or tāuga, which comes to Nanumea (both its sea and its land) when the lineages of Tepaa or Teilo reign.
- The Tūmau lineage serves the chiefs as "Chiefs of the Sea," Te Aliko o te Tai.
- Nanumea has several other lineages of chiefs which have special roles to play in serving the reigning chief, including Tufa and Nifo
- There is a special caretaker role to watch over or care for the chieftainship, and to

Aliko/Pulefenua o fakatonu mana fai e i ai mea hē tonu e fai ki te fenua.

suggest corrections if things are going badly on the island.

Tala Fakahokohoko

A faifaiga o Nanumea e uiga ki ona faiga aliki e hekeheke kae fakatau 'futi. E uke a hekehekega i mea folikiliki pelā hoki mo faiga lahi ki luga o te fakavae akega o te aliki o Nanumea. E i ai ni toeaina ni tavili ki te mea tenei mo Kiti mo Ane, i te taimi o te huhukuega a lāua i Nanumea i te tauhaga 1970+ mo te 1980+. A te fakamunaga e fai pelā: "E hē tahi a te tala," me "E fifi a te tala," me "E euke a fakamatalaga." A tala fakahokohoko koa pili o fakamatala mai lalo nei koa palu fakatahi mea hekeheke mai loto i tala lahi e lua (tala mai ia kāiga o Takitua mo Tepou).

A tala mua e tafa mai nei, ni hau ia Takitua, tala mai te Kāiga o Vaha: A te tala e tahi tenei, ni talagina e te toeaina ko Vaha i te Āhiga i Nanumea ia Me 1984. A Kiti ni fano ki te Āhiga o ahi ki toeaina, a te toko ukega o lātou e filo kolokolo ki olotou kauaga kae fai'tala, fakatoka o 'kave o 'togi ki te tino fakatau mea taulima, koa pili o hau mai Funafuti. A te faitalaga ni mafuli ki te galuega a Kiti mo Ane ki te tuhiga o tala mua e uiga ki faiga aliki. A Vaha ni tala e ia ki tino konei he tala toetoe o Tefolaha, mo ana āvaga mo ana tamaliki.

A te tala a Vaha e kāmata pelā ailoa mo tala a Tepou mo Takitua. A Tefolaha ni hau ki Nanumea, fakalo'i'loi e ia a Pai mo Vau kae toe foki ki tona fenua tonu. Kae ni toe foki hoki ki Nanumea mo tana āvaga ko Puleala, kae ni fai a lā tama e toko fa, ka e hē toko tolu. A tamaliki konei (pelā mo te tala a Takitua) ko Tutaki, Fiaola mo Lavega, ka e i ai hoki he olotou tuagane ko Koli. Ka koa tai 'lahi a lātou konei, a Tefolaha ni fakatoka o tiaki a Nanumea o toe foki atu ki Samoa. Kae koi tuai o fano, ni tuku e ia ki ana tama tagata taki toko tahi mo olotou vaega e fai. A Tutaki ko ia e pule i te Tufa, kae ko Fiaola e noho i te Nifo, kae ko Lavega ni tuku ki ai a te aliki. Kae ni fai atu a Lavega ki tona tamana, "Ikai, tuku a te aliki (pule) ki a Koli kae tuku mai a te mataili ki a te aku." Muna a Koli, "Ikai, tuku a te mataili ki a te aku, kae noho mo koe a te filifiliga o te aliki." Koa noho nei ailoa penā, ke oko mai ki pō nei.

I te tala tenei ni talagina e Vaha, a telega katoa konei, fakatahi mo te telega o Koli, ni 'tupu mai katoa ia Tefolaha mo tana āvaga ko Puleala. Ko te telega o Koli ni fanaifo kae ni tū kia Tepou mo ana kau kāiga. Kae ko te telega o Lavega, fanaifo ko te mea ailoa koa maga (pelā mo te tala a Takitua) maua mai i ai a Teilo mo Tepaa, pelā hoki mo tinā maga aliki konei e lua. A te fakatokaga a Vaha ki te "'fifi o tala konei" ko mafai i ai fakaiakupelā me i te

Bridging Traditions

Nanumea's traditions about its chieftainship exist in competing versions. There are many differences in small details, as well as some differences in the key structural relationships which ground the chieftainship. Some elders commented on this to Anne and Keith during their work in Nanumea in the 1970's and 1980's, saying: e hē tahi te tala, "there is not just one story," or e fifi te tala, "the story is tangled," or e uke a fakamatalaga, "there are many explanations."

Vaha's Story: One of these stories was offered by Vaha in Nanumea's āhiga in May 1984. Keith had gone to the Āhiga to visit with some elderly men, most of whom were rolling kolokolo cord on their thighs as they talked, getting ready to sell the cord to the handicraft buyer who would soon be coming from Funafuti. The talk turned to Keith and Anne's work in recording the traditional history of the chieftainship. Vaha offered a brief account of Tefolaha, his wives, and his children.

Vaha's story began as had that of Tepou and Takitua. Tefolaha came to Nanumea, tricked Pai and Vau, and returned to his homeland. He returned to Nanumea with his wife Puleala, and they had not three children but four. These children were (as in Takitua's story) Tutaki, Fiaola and Lavega, but also a sister, Koli! After these children were grown, Tefolaha prepared to leave Nanumea again and return to Samoa. Before he left, he gave to each of his three sons a vaega, "portion" of responsibility. Tutaki was to distribute (tufa), and Fiaola was to apportion (nifo) foods in the Āhiga. Lavega was given the chieftainship, but he said to his father, "No, leave it to Koli and leave me the mataili." Koli replied, "No, leave the mataili to me and you take the role of choosing, filifiliga, the chief." And so it was, down to this day.

In this version presented by Vaha, all of these lineages, including Koli's, stem from Tefolaha and his wife Puleala. Koli's line comes down to Tepou and others related to him. Lavega's line eventually branches (as Takitua's story says) to produce Teilo and Tepaa and the two main branches of chiefs. Vaha explained that he had shared his story

fakatelega tonu mai mua, e 'tau o maua i te tuku fakatahi o mea tāua mai tala konei e lua.

Te Tala mai te Kāiga o Tolugafua: A te tala tenei e tahi mai te kāiga o Tolugafua ni maua mai ia Faiva, mokopuna o Tolugafua i Nanumea i Tesema 2003. E tala mai me ia Tefolaha he toa mai Tonga ni tupu mai te gafa o te feao ko Sagone, telā ni liu fonu. Ni malaga a Tefolaha ki Nanumea kae ni tuli ke ātea a Pai mo Vau. Ni noho a Tefolaha i Nanumea kae ni fai a tona āvaga ki te feao e igoa ki Laukite kae fai tama lāua.

A Tefolaha ni folau atu ki tona tuagane telā e noho i Tonga, ni fakamolemole atu tefolaha kia Hinamoe ke hahala he ana āvaga. Ni faipoipo a Tefolaha mo Puleala i Tonga, mea ailoa koa malaga atu ki Nanumea. E toko tolu a tama tagata o Tefolaha mo Puleala, ko Tutaki, Fiaola mo Lavega. I te vaitiāmi mai tua ifo ne toe mafaukau a Tefolaha ke toe fai he ana malaga, telā lā ni kalaga atu ki ana tama katoa ke maopopopo mai. Ni tavili atu ki ana tama penei: "A koe e Tūtaki, a koe ko taku tama tagata lahi. A tou tui (tofi) ko te nifo – te katikati mo te helehele – mo te tufa. Ko koe Fiaola ko taku tama tagata i te toko lua. A tou tui ko te olioli mo te fakatāula. Kae ko koe Lāvega ko taku tama tagata foliki. A tou tui ko te papa aliki."

Kae e fai a Tefolaha ki ana tama tagata: "A koutou katoa aku tama tāgata, e aga kae tauti faka 'lei te otou tuagane ko Koli. A mea katoa e loto ki ai a Koli e tatau ailoa o fai. Ka fai e i ai ni otou meakai, ke hau a te otou tuagane o pula kae puke meakai katoa e loto a ia ki ai."

I te tala a Tolugafua ko Koli ko te tuagane a Tutaki, Fiaola mo Lavega, ka ko te matua a Koli ko te atua ko Laukite, ka ko te matua o ona tuagane tāgata ko Puleala, he fafine Tonga. Pelā hoki mo te tala mai ia Vaha, a te aliki ni tuku e Tefolaha kia Lavega, kae e i ai pologa lagolago koa tuku kia ona taina ake. Kae ko te tufa mo te nifo fakatahi e tuku ki a Tutaki mo ona kau kāiga ailoa, kae ko Fiaola mo tona kāiga ni tofi olioli mo te hokotakimaiga o muna mai feao ki te Aliko.

E 'tau nei o mānava mālie kae ke fakatau ia tala konei koa oti ni fakaali mai. A tala konei koa 'folā mai a faiga mo fakavaeakega tāua 'kī mo te aliki o Nanumea. A tala takitahi e hau mai muna mo logo e tuku ki lalo i he kāiga e tahi. Kae fai e fakahokohoko a tala katoa, koa maua he ata mau mea atu mo katoatoa atu ia tala takitahi. Telā lā, atu lā a tala konei e uke a 'lou fifiga koa mafai o taku pelā me ko he vaega o maumea o te fenua o Nanumea.

Mai Tonga me Mai Samoa?

because he felt it offered a way out of the dilemma created by Takitua's and Tepou's opposed stories.

Tolugafua's Story: This family story, told by Tolugafua, was offered to Keith and Anne at Nanumea by his grandson Faiva in December, 2003. This story describes Tefolaha as a Tongan warrior, descended from the turtle spirit Sagone, with a long lineage of Tongan ancestors. Tefolaha voyaged to Nanumea and chased away Pai and Vau. He stayed on Nanumea and married the spirit (feao) named Laukite and had children with her.

Tefolaha then returned to his sister in Tonga and asked her to find him a wife. Tefolaha married Puleala in Tonga and they returned to Nanumea, where they had three sons: Tutaki, Fiaola and Lavega. At some point after this, Tefolaha decided to begin voyaging again. So he gathered all four of his children together and spoke to them as follows: "Tutaki, my first son, your responsibility is the Nifo, dividing (katikati and helehele), and Tufa, distribution. Fiaola, my second son, your responsibility is priestly functions between the chief and the gods (olioli and fakatāula). Lavega, my youngest son, your responsibility is the ruling chieftainship (te papa aliki)."

Tefolaha went on to tell his three sons that they must care very diligently (tausi faka 'lei) for their sister Koli. "Anything that Koli desires must be given to her. If you have food, your sister may inspect it and chose whatever she wishes to eat." Tefolaha left Nanumea in the care of his children and resumed his voyaging.

Tolugafua's story also presents Koli as a sister of Tutaki, Fiaola and Lavega, though her mother is the spirit, Laukite, while theirs is the Tongan woman Puleala. As in the story by Vaha, the chieftainship was given by Tefolaha to Lavega and the other brothers were given supporting roles. However, both the Tufa and Nifo responsibilities are given to Tutaki and his descendants alone, while Fiaola and his descendants are made responsible for priestly functions.

Let's take a moment and step back to consider the stories we've just presented. They provide a wealth of information on the origin of our chiefly system. Each story has its own important points to make and each presents slightly differing details. Individually, each story comes from one family's tradition. Taken together, they give us a richer and more complete picture than any single story could. So perhaps our many "tangled traditions" (fifi a tala) are in fact a form of wealth for Nanumea.

From Tonga or from Samoa?

E uke a kāiga i Nanumea e tali tonu me ia Tefolaha e hau mai Tonga. Kāiga ake e fai mai me e hau mai Samoa. Ke pula ake faka'lei ki te mea tenei.

A tino e o olotou kāiga tala mua e fakamatala me ko Tefolaha e afu mai Tonga e fakatino mai muna mo fakamunaga o te 'gana Nanumea e tai 'pau mo te 'gana Tonga. Pelā mo te mata i manu "h," e fakamailoga te 'gana Nanumea (pelā hoki mo te 'gana Nanumaga) i Tuvalu, koa maua hoki i te 'gana Tonga, kae hē ai i te 'gana Samoa. E i ai hoki fakatelega mo gafa mai Nanumea ni maua fakamuli nei koa fakatino mai uke mea foliki ki luga i te gafa a Tefolaha i Tonga mai mua i tona okomaiga ki Nanumea.

Pelā mo tala mai te kāiga o Tepou, e i ai hoki tala mua e fai me ko te fenua o Tefolaha ko Samoa. A mea konei mai lalo ni maua i te lipoti ni tuhigina e te LMS misionale ko George A. Turner i te otiga o tona malaga ki Nanumea i te 1874:

A Moiono [ko te pule o Nanumea i te taimi tenā] ni aumai gina he mea fakafofo. A te mea tenei he 'tootoo' [he kaukini a te tino failauga] a te tamana o tino Nanumea. Mai luga i olotou tala a lātou ni tupu mai i te tagata e igoa kia Folasa, he Samoa, telā ni tapea keatea mai tona fenua, kae ni āke i Nanumea.... A olotou muna me mai te taimi nei mai a Folasa koa 31 o kautama.

A te kaukini a te tulāfale telā ni tuku kia Turner i Nanumea i te 1874 hēmotuhia ko te ketuketu e talatala mai i tala mua o Nanumea me ko te ketuketu a Tefolaha. Pelā mo muna a taumatua e uke, e lua a mea ni aumai ki Nanumea a Tefolaha: tona ketuketu mo te Kaumaile. Muna a taumatua, tino mai te mālō faka Kolone Peletania ni kave ki tua mai Nanumea te Kaumaile mo te ketuketu a Tefolaha, o hukehuke i ai. Mai tua atu, a te Kaumaile koa fakafoki, kae hē ko te ketuketu.

Me tehea tona fenua tonu, a te ukega o tala mua mai Nanumea koa fai me ko Tefolaha he toa ni fai malaga mai Samoa ki Tonga kae fokifoki ki fenua kolā faka fia. Hē motuhia me i a te ia e i ai he hokoga mālosi i fenua kolā e lua.

Te Fitu Maga o Aliko

E mahani o ta'vili tele a tino i tuahaga 1970+ mo 1980+ ki maga o aliki o Nanumea ki "Te Kau Aliko." E fakaigoa hoki a te putukau tenei ki te "tinogofula mo te toko lua." I pō nei e fai me e i ai "fitu maga o aliki." Maga kolā e fitu e aofia i te "te toko fitu" e penei:

- Te Aliko a Mua (Pihelea)

Many Nanumean families believe that Tefolaha was from Tonga. Others say he was from Samoa. Let's look at this issue in more detail.

People whose family traditions say that Tefolaha was from Tonga point to the existence of words and expressions in the Nanumean language that are very similar to Tongan. For example, the letter "h," which sets the Nanumean language apart from the rest of Tuvalu (except Nanumaga), is also found in Tongan but not in Samoan. Some recently collected Nanumean genealogies also provide considerable detail on Tefolaha's Tongan lineage before he came to Nanumea, even mentioning his sister and other relatives.

However, as we saw with the family story of Tepou, there are also traditions which say that Tefolaha's homeland was Samoa. The following material is from a report written by LMS missionary George A. Turner after his visit to Nanumea in 1874:

Moiono [a Nanumean leader of the day] also presented me with a great curiosity. It was the 'tootoo' [orator's staff] of the father of the Nanumeans. According to their tradition they are sprung from a man called Folasa, a Samoan, who was drifted away from his home and reached Nanumea... They say the present generation is the 31st from Folasa.

The orator's staff that Turner was given in Nanumea in 1874 is probably the staff remembered in Nanumean oral tradition as Tefolaha's ketuketu, cane. According to many elders, Tefolaha brought two things with him to Nanumea: his ketuketu cane, and the Kaumaile war spear. Elders also say that early in the colonial days British officials took away from Nanumea both the Kaumaile and the ketuketu for analysis. Later the Kaumaile was returned, but not the ketuketu.

Regardless of where he was from, most Nanumean family traditions present Tefolaha as a warrior who went back and forth many times between Samoa and Tonga. He must have had strong ties to both places.

The Seven Branches of Chiefs

It was customary for people in the 1970s and 1980s to talk about the group of chiefly lineages as the "Kau Aliko," Council of Chiefs. This group was also described as "The Twelve," te tinogafulu mo te tokoua. Today, people usually say there are seven branches, fitu maga o aliki. The seven chiefly

- Te Aliko a Muli
- Tūmau (te Aliko o te Tai)
- Tuinanumea
- Taualepuku
- Pāheiloa (Fakavalevale)
- Pologa

A maga konei ko maga e mātea i te 1970+ mo 1980+. A te maga Tūmau e ana te filifiga, fakahopoga mo tufuifoga o te aliki hopo. Muna a tino, e 'lei atu mana fai e fakahopo te maga Te Aliko a Mua me ko te maga Te Aliko a Muli.

A tino toko uke koa fai i pō nei me a te aofaki o maga o aliki koa oti ni lahi atu i tauhaga koa olo. E mai a te tokoukega o tino me i faifaiga mua, a pulepulega faka aliki mua o Nanumea, e lua ailoa a maga me ni telega aliki e mafai o faka'hopo ki te nohoaga/papa. A maga konei ko te aliki a mua (mai mua) mo te aliki mai tua (muli), me ko te aliki muamua mo te aliki i te lua. A lātou kolā e 'lago ki te manatu tenei, e fai me ko te fakahopo o he maga ake ki te Pulefenua koa soli e ia a te fakavae o Nanumea.

E māina 'kī me i faiga faka aliki o Nanumea koa i ai ni fakalavelavemaiga e uke i te sentenali mo te afa (150 tauhaga) koa olo. A hekehekega mo faigatā i pō nei o talia a tino ki te filiga o te Pulefenua/Aliko e hau mai te uke mo te fifiga o tala mua e uiga ki maga aliki.

I pō nei te tokoukega o tātou koa halahala te "mea tonu" e uiga ki te kamataga mo faifaiga faka Nanumea. E manakogina ko faifaiga konei ke maua o fakavae ki ai a pulepulega a te kau aliki, telā koa mafai i ai o fakalagolago a manakoga o te fenua i loto o te 21 senetenali tenei. He mea e tāua ke lavea e tātou a te uke, ka e hē 'pau, a tala mai tou tino ma'tua, tela ko te mea tonu tenei e halahala a tātou ki ai. Ka e 'tau mo tātou o fia'fia kae 'lifu ki te i ai o hekehekega konei o o'tou tala maua, telā ko mafai o fakaaogā mo ati ake a te fakavae mo te atafata mālosi. A "nino" o te iloa/mahala mai feitu mo tala mua katoa konei, fakatahi mo iloa mai te Mata o Muna 3 e uiga ki te āhiga, e mafai e tātou o fakaaogā o 'fili fakatahi he filiga faka vaipua mālosi kae tūmau.

branches that are included today in "The Seven" are as follows:

- Te Aliko a Mua (Pihelea)
- Te Aliko a Muli
- Tūmau (te Aliko o te Tai)
- Tuinanumea
- Taualepuku
- Pāheiloa (Fakavalevale)
- Pologa

The seven branches listed above were also the same ones that were recognized in the 1970's and 1980's. The Tūmau branch is given the role of overseeing the selection, installation and stepping down of the reigning chiefs. People prefer that a reigning chief come from the Aliko a Mua and Aliko a Muli branches.

Many people say that the number of chiefly branches has probably increased over the years. Most people say that the traditional form of the chieftainship of Nanumea had just two branches or lines of chiefs who could hopo, sit in the seat. These were the two lineages Aliko a Mua and the Aliko a Muli, the front and back chiefs, or the first and second chiefs. Those who support this view argue that for any other branch to sit in the seat is to violate the traditional constitution of Nanumea.

It is clear that the chiefly traditions of Nanumea have been interfered with greatly over the last 150 years. As Chapter 4 will explain, changes imposed on Nanumea's local government have made it difficult for the community to maintain full knowledge of local political traditions. Today's difficulties also surely stem from the nature of oral tradition, in which different versions of these valuable histories co-exist and compete against each other.

Today, many of us are searching for the "true" origins and traditions of Nanumea. We need these traditions to provide a basis for our chieftainship so that it can serve the community's needs in the 21st century. However, it is important for us all to recognize that the rich, yet varied, traditions of our elders are that truth we are seeking. The fact that the stories are not unified and that the historical past of Nanumea is complex should not discourage us.

Let us celebrate the existence of these different traditions, which we can use to build a foundation for a strong future. Strands of knowledge from all these traditions can be used, together with information from Chapter 3 about the āhiga, to braid together a strong traditional rope, he filiga faka vaipua. This rope of Nanumean traditional political organization is

A te fakavaipua (lopu) mālosi tenei o faifaiga faka
pulepulega faka Nanumea e mafai o fakaaogā o
taula faka 'lei ki ai a te fenua i pō mai mua nei.

what we need to anchor our community securely in
the future.